

VIT FOUNDER & CHANCELLOR DR. G. VISWANATHAN

AWARDED DOCTORATE BY ST. XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

Kolkata, February 15, 2025: In a momentous occasion at the 6th Convocation Ceremony of St. Xavier's University, Kolkata, Dr. G. Viswanathan, Founder and Chancellor of Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), was conferred with the prestigious Doctor of Literature (D.Litt., Honoris Causa). The honor was bestowed upon him in recognition of his outstanding contributions to education, leadership, public service, and humanitarian efforts.

The convocation ceremony, held at the Biswa Bangla Convention Centre, New Town, was presided over by Hon'ble Chancellor Rev. Dr. James Arjen Tete, S.J & Vice-Chancellor Rev Dr. John Felix Raj. The event featured a distinguished gathering of academicians, dignitaries, students, and esteemed guests. The Convocation Address was delivered by Mr. Justice I. P. Mukherji, Chief Justice of the High Court of Meghalaya.

Dr. Viswanathan, an eminent educationist and visionary leader, has played a pivotal role in transforming higher education in India. This recognition marks the first time an Indian university has conferred an honorary doctorate upon him. Previously, he was honored with an honorary doctorate by West Virginia University, USA, in 2009, and more recently by the State University of New York, Binghamton University, USA, in 2024.

Expressing gratitude for the honor, Dr. Viswanathan thanked St. Xavier's University for conferring the Honoris Causa oh him and recollected his long association with Bengal. He emphasized the importance of quality education and research in shaping the future of the nation. He reaffirmed his commitment to fostering academic excellence and societal development. He also emphasized the importance of growth in Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) for an improved economic development.

Prominent dignitaries from VIT, Vice-Presidents Mr. Sankar Viswanathan & Dr. Sekar Viswanathan, Vice-Chancellor – Dr. Kanchana Bhaaskaran, Pro-Vice Chancellor Dr. Partha Sharathi Mallick, Director -Alumni Affairs Dr. Elizabeth Rufus, Fr. Dominic Gomes, Vicar general Archdiocese of Calcutta, Fr. Malay Dcosta, Financial Administrator, Archdiocese of Calcutta, Fr. Jayraj Veluswamy, SJ, Rector St. Xavier's College Calcutta were present during this historic occasion.